# mixed media

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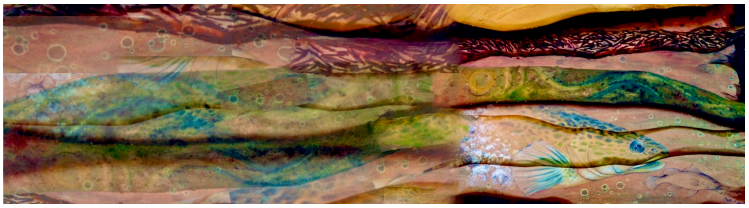
Tea Tree Gully 1982, 1.8m long X 1.5m high on thick linen blend rough canvas

This painting, that won a Townsville Pacific Painting Award, was my first mixed up media relief artwork. It was composed with oil, wax, acrylic, rolled canvas, printed photos and found objects consisting of weeds, leaves twigs, geckos, lizards, green ants and a butterfly.

Just like conceiving most of my artforms, it comes with an idea out of the blue and the only changes are the 'controlled chances' of interactions with the materials involved. It depends nurturing the effect or deliberately clashing the media to see what happens.

Sometimes (only sometimes) the dichotomy of being a pedantic designer and simultaneously, a free-willed artist, can be a dilemma for the process, the parameters and the aesthetic. It can be quite stimulating! When I attend other peoples exhibitions, I can always tell if a painter has a trained designer background… usually always.

The detail from the painting below was commissioned by the Balonne Shire Council for the foyer of their office in St George.

It was more of a woodcarving, drawing, painting to capture the industries of the area. Strategic lighting plays an important role in casting shadows to emphasise the depth of the artwork.